(i) Basic ingredients

- **Flour** - Normally a mixture of soft and medium flour in a particular proportion is used for rich cakes like wedding cakes, Christmas cakes and special birthday cakes



Plate 4.11 **Basic Ingredients**

Functions

- Provide good structure
- Determine the shelf life of product.
- Improve nutritional merits
- Act as an absorbing and a binding agent
- Improve the adhering capacity of ingredients and distributes evenly in the mixture.

Sugar

Coarsely powdered sugar is more suitable for cake making. Liquid sugars like honey, molasses, invert sugar can also be used. These impart special flavour and improves colour of cake crust.

Functions

- Provides taste
- Acts as a tenderizer
- Holds moisture
- Helps in acquiring volume in cakes
- Gives a golden brown crust colour when caramelized.

DO YOU KNOW?

Caramelization is the oxidation of sugar, a process used extensively in cooking for the resulting nutty flavour and brown colour

Fat

Fat is the main ingredient in cake preparation.

Functions

- Helps the product to be tender
- Improves shelf life by holding the moisture for a longer time
- Enhances the flavour and aroma
- Provides nutritional importance as well as softness.
- Holds the air during creaming.

Eggs

Fresh eggs are used for cake preparations. Eggs should be at room temperature (21-24°C) at the time of adding into the mixture. Eggs are beaten during creaming operation because once the eggs are beaten, the small air cells are incorporated and it will increase the number of air cells in the mixture.

Functions

- Provides structure, gives moisture and colour
- Improves the flavour, taste, volume